# Warm-up exercises - INF201 2026

The following exercises will allow you to refresh your Python knowledge, in preparation for the rest of the course.

## Task 1 - Setting up

If you don't have it already, download Python to your machine. We recommend using the latest version (3.14), but any version >= 3.11 will do.

- Windows users can get Python from the Microsoft app store
- Mac users can get Python via Homebrew
- Linux users should be able to get it from your package manager
- Anyone can download Python directly from the Python website

Download Visual Studio Code (unless you already have a preferred IDE you want to use instead) from their website (or from the Microsoft app store)

- Read through the general Visual Studio Code (VSC) tutorial
- Read through the Python in VSC tutorial
- Consider installing these useful extensions in VSC:
  - ruff for linting and format checking
  - mypy for type checking
  - Jupyter, which we will use for the deliverables later in the course

Set up a virtual environment (venv) for these warm-up exercises

- In general, we recommend setting up a new venv whenever you start a new project
- In VSC you can easily set up a venv by opening the command palette (Ctrl+Shift+P) typing Python: Create Environment and selecting venv
- You can also create a venv using the venv module directly

## Task 2 - User input

Write a script that asks the user for an integer between 1 and 10. The script should then print all integers starting with 1 and ending with the input number.

## Task 3 - String formatting

Write a script that prints a nicely formatted table of the alphabet (A-Z) with both upper-case and lower-case letters. You can base this solution on imported modules or use built-in functions only. (Or why not try both?)

## Task 4 - Working with files

Copy the file "norway_municipalities_2017.csv" into your working directory. This file contains information about the Norwegian municipalities for the 2017 national election, specifically which district each municipality belongs to, as well as their population.

- Write a script that reads from this file and prints a table showing the number of municipalities and total population of each district.
- Plot a figure that shows the total population in each district.